



Wireless charging for cars

By 2017, electric cars could be charged wirelessly using wireless charging pads
<http://dgit.in/WirelessChrgCar>



Hide unwanted games

Too many games in your Steam library? Follow this link to know how to hide unwanted ones and declutter it: <http://dgit.in/HideGames>

Feature



Entertainment news covered the news of celebrities' private lives based on an anonymous Whisper secret. Patently false

in the real world. In February 2014, a post from Secret started trending on Twitter which claimed that "Evernote is about to get acquired". Such a sensitive and secretive piece of corporate information would normally be protected by law but with the freedom of anonymous sharing, it can neither be verified or unverified. The news created ripples in the market with significant energy being diverted to business speculations – all on the basis of a false rumour.

The question is "how anonymous"?

Although these services assure they use state-of-the-art technologies to protect your privacy, the fine print of their policies seems less convincing. For instance, Whisper states in its privacy policy docu-

ment that there's no guarantee that your message data will be completely deleted and that "any Message Data you send is sent at your own risk". Secret's privacy policy, although more stringent on protection, also doesn't guarantee that your information – login info, IP addresses, pages visited, time of visit, etc. – won't be shared with "third-party partners".

Even today, you can check out a website called Whisper Stories (www.whisper.sh) which regularly features curated lists of secrets shared on the app based on themes. The website can monetise this content without any problems because the owners of these secrets have already forfeited the exclusive ownership rights over them by signing up and using the app (should've read the Terms of Service, but really, who does?). Essentially, anonymity isn't a guarantee.

The real virtue of anonymity

The USP of these apps is that they provide a form of emotional, psychological and social protection when users risk self-expression. But for us to believe that these anonymous social networks and sharing systems are a new phase of online interaction will be a mistake. We know this because we're social creatures and tend to reach towards community and friends. This shouldn't be mistaken for "having friends" or even "liking people" but the expression of the evolutionary initiative – that we're better off together rather than by ourselves. After all, PostSecret started years before any of the current apps came along and was a genuinely interactive (and anonymous) social experiment that brought people together in a meaningful way.

It's a good thing we don't always feel free to impulsively express what we think and have to "think twice" before speaking. Words have power, speech has a cost and ideas pack quite a punch. In most spaces – public, private and political – we're obligated to strive for honesty and authenticity. To realise that sometimes what we think can be extremely hurtful, dangerous and stupid. To speak the truth as we see it, even if it comes at a cost. To be accountable and have the integrity of our claims.

Of course, not all scenarios deserve such stringent ethics and in hard times, under political persecution or when enduring quiet lives of desperation, it's



Anonymity is critical for the success of political movements, but it's used online mostly for juvenile reasons like bullying and trolling

necessary to have a medium that doesn't restrict us from speaking out. But the moment we begin covering behind technology because we can't muster the courage of our convictions and become petty gossiping troglodytes who speak out only in the darkness so that our faces can't be seen, we'll lose our humanity, our society and all our sharing will be on the network but it won't be social.



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